SEPTEMBER 2025

Project Proposal

CYCLE CARE

SUSTAINING TODAY, SHAPING TOMORROW

PRESENTED TO:

CEP Management

PRESENTED BY:

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What is Cycle Care?

The most sustainable item is the one that already exists. Right now, it's collecting dust in someone's closet, but what if it could be the very piece of someone else's future? Cycle Care makes sustainability its core practice, saving money, cutting waste, and helping the community through mutual aid

U.S. landfills reported receiving 11.3 million tons of waste in 2018; only 7.7% of Municipal Solid Waste was landfilled. (EPA 2024)

Problem

Many students **want** a more sustainable life, but lack **clear** guidance, **easy** access to materials, and **consistent** incentives. As a result, usable items end up in landfills, forcing students to spend money on replacements. An issue that adds pressure to both their academic focus and economic security.

Solution

A practical student-led program that brings together campus communities through donation and clothing drives, DIY workshops, and an online platform presence. Conducted between two campuses (SDCC & UCLA), sharing templates others can reuse, measuring outcomes in materials diverted, students reached, and partners engaged.

Extending a garment's life by just nine months can cut its carbon, water, and waste footprint by 20-30%. (WRAP 2024)

Mission

Empower students to reduce waste and circulate resources on campus through hands-on learning and low-barrier actions that become habits.

Impact

Usable items will be diverted from landfills with clothing drives, and essential items will be redistributed to students at Basic Needs Centers on each campus. Media coverage through a social media campaign will promote engagement and pledges to incentivize action.

Connection

We've seen classmates struggle with tight budgets and limited schedules. From our positions in campus clubs and community initiatives. We are well-positioned to organize events, build relationships, and design solutions that respond to real student needs.

We know that as students, we need simple, affordable ways to reuse, upcycle, and access resources. By tapping into our lived experiences and peer networks, we can make sustainability practical and approachable. Our project reflects our commitment to working alongside our community, fostering a sustainable campus practice, and nurturing a lasting culture of care for both the planet and its people.

Goals

Divert 300 lbs. of usable goods
Metric: Weight (lbs recorded at two campus donation/clothes drives by Nov. 23, 2025

Redistribute 200 essential items to students via Basic Needs Centers
Metric: Number of items logged and redistributed by Nov. 23, 2025

Secure 200 pledges
Metric: Pledge submission forms with survey feedback by Nov 23, 2025

Deliverables

Campus Clothes Drive Events

Hosting in-person events to reduce campus waste and redistribute essential clothes to students in need. We host these drives for a maximum of 3 hours, and co-host events on the same day at each respective campus (SDCC & UCLA). Locations will be on campus in high-traffic areas, pre-promoted before setting up. Materials for the SDCC's location (Table, canopy, cover, and bins) will be provided by faculty at said campus due to being an established club. Materials for the UCLA location will be limited, and this location will not be an established club due to the feasibility with the timeline. Creating opportunity through adaptability, the SDCC location will focus on the bulk of the clothes drive gathering, collaborations, and engagement, while UCLA can focus on more pledges and online campaign bandwidth.

DIY Workshops

Build sustainable habits by hosting a creative, hands-on event that translates to reducing consumption habits. 30-45 minute workshops with activities that will teach students about upcycling. Utilizing just an old shirt and some fabric scissors to make tote bags. We'll also hold an opportunity to customize (tie-dyeing) totes that were given away at the clothes drives for people who followed our Instagram and signed our pledge. Sustaining long-term change by equipping students with hands-on knowledge and through creative expression!

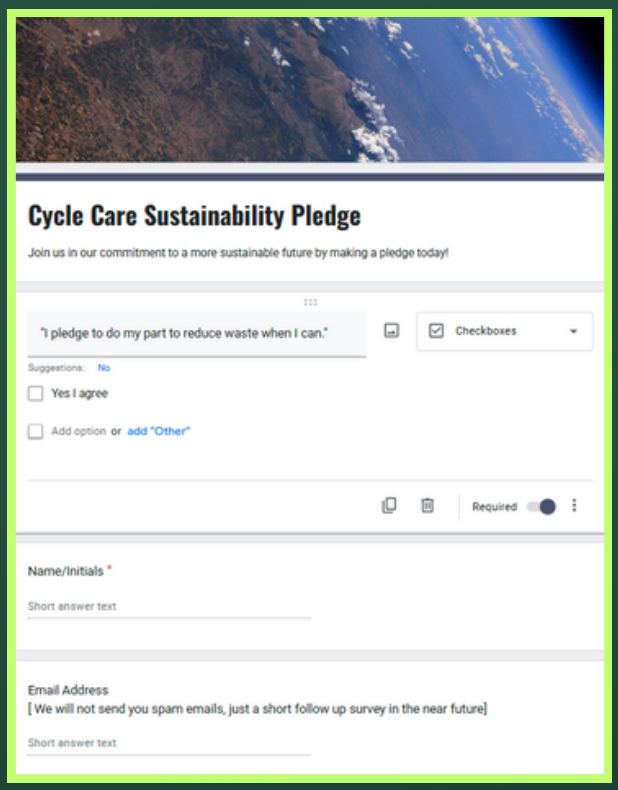
DELIVERABLES

Social Media Campaign (@cyclecareproject)

Online presence sharing our promotional posts for upcoming events, pledges, and other resources (other initiatives, communities, volunteering opportunities). We'll also post alternative swaps and create Instagram reels for quick and concise content. Increasing our visibility on Instagram will help spread the reuse culture and build a community with peer-to-peer motivation.

Pledge Campaign

Supporting our goal of creating lasting student habits around sustainability and environmental impact. A simple pledge can turn abstract awareness into a concrete action plan. Pledges turn obscurity into symbolic commitment, reducing the barriers and ensuring immediate action. Setting up a Google Form to record and measure signees, including names for signature and/or emails for follow-up surveys. Pledges can then be showcased on social media or at events as a measurable goal or milestone, creating public accountability and encouraging more students to join.



Timeline

1

Week 1 (Sep 15-21): Setup & Foundation

- Reach out to Lisa Chaddock for an interview.
- Set up the Cycle Care club at SDCC and prepare event scheduling and reserve materials for both campus sites.
- Apply for funding.

2

Week 2 (Sep 22-28): Branding & Outreach

- Publish intro posts on IG and prepare promotional reels.
- Publish pledge.
- Establish the Cycle Care club at SDCC
- Promote next week's clothes drive event for SDCC and UCLA campuses
  - Rafael creates visuals
  - Winnie creates posts and captions on Instagram.

3

Week 3 (Sep 29-Oct 5): Clothes Drive Week

- Host event on the SDCC campus and the UCLA campus.
- Repost the event drive location and time on Instagram story the day of the event.
- Film reels/pictures at each location,
- Track items donated, pledges signed, and Instagram follows.

4

Week 4 (Oct 6-12): Buffer week

- Post sustainability swaps on Instagram
  - Winnie post and captions, research.
  - Rafael makes the visuals/reels
- Post a mini-challenge for people to attempt in the form of reels.
  - Encourage people to tag us and use our hashtag so we can repost their videos - measure engagements.
  - Winnie researches ideas, posts, and captions
  - Rafael creates visuals/.reels
- Promote next week's clothes drive, and upcoming DIY Workshop

5

Week 5 (Oct 13-19) Clothes Drive Week 2

- Host event on the SDCC campus and the UCLA campus.
- Repost the event drive location and time on Instagram story the day of the event.
- Film reels/pictures at each location,
- Track items donated, pledges signed, and Instagram follows.
- Promote DIY workshop next week

6

Week 6 (Oct 20-26) Workshop Week

- Host workshop event on the SDCC campus and the UCLA campus.
- Repost the event drive location and time on Instagram story the day of the event.
- Film reels/pictures at each location,
- Track attendance, pledges signed, and Instagram follows.
- Promote clothes drive for next week.

Timeline

7

Week 7 (Oct 27-Nov 2): Clothes Drive Week 3

- Host event on the SDCC campus and the UCLA campus.
- Repost the event drive location and time on Instagram story the day of the event.
- Film reels/pictures at each location,
- Track items donated, pledges signed, and Instagram follows.

8

Week 8 (Nov 3-9): Buffer Week

- Post sustainability swaps on Instagram
- Winnie post and captions, research.
- Rafael makes the visuals/reels
- Post a mini-challenge for people to attempt in the form of reels.
- Encourage people to tag us and use our hashtag so we can repost their videos - measure engagements.
- Winnie researches ideas, posts, and captions
- Rafael creates visuals/.reels
- Promote next week's clothes drive and upcoming DIY Workshop

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Week 9 (Nov 10- 16): Clothes Drive Week 4

- Host event on the SDCC campus and the UCLA campus.
- Repost the event drive location and time on Instagram story the day of the event.
- Film reels/pictures at each location,
- Track items donated, pledges signed, and Instagram follows.

10

Week 10 (Nov 17-23): Wrap-Up Week

- Post appreciation online for all who supported. Wrap up the project and provide statistics to let people know of the impact they've helped with making!
- Email all pledge email follow-up surveys to those who consented.
- Start compiling all data

11

Week 11 (Nov 24-30) Presentation Preparation Week

- Gather and finalize all data: lbs. diverted, pledge count, workshop attendance, video analytics.
- Organize visuals: charts, photos, reels, testimonials.
- Draft presentation slides
- Rehearse as a team

12

Week 12 (Dec 1-8) Final Impact Report

- Compile a full impact report with a data dashboard.
- Highlight measurable outcomes
- Include reflections on challenges, lessons, and sustainability/ club handoff.
- Submit final report.

Obstacle

- Low engagement at booths and a lack of awareness of the project.

Contingency

- To address this obstacle, we look towards collaborating with professors to ask if we can speak to their students briefly before their lectures.
- We can increase content output in our online presence and get other clubs and communities to follow and shout us out.

Obstacle

- Unable to hold events due to scheduling or external conflicts.

Contingency

- If one person can not hold an event on their end, or both, the other member will persist with their event at their location. If both members can not hold an event, we will notify all platforms to update people on the news.
- We will post online content to compensate, and if possible, we will move the event to the next available buffer week.

Obstacle

- Running out of funds/ or tote bags

Contingency

- While we plan to be mindful and frugal in our budget, we plan to give out tote bags as incentives. In the event that we run out of supplies, we will pivot to putting more emphasis on the donation clothing drive. The tote bags would not be used as an incentive anymore.
- We will try to inform others and link them to tutorial resources, teaching them how to create tote bags out of old shirts as an alternative.

Meet the Team

Winnie Bai

"My first ever exposure to the concept of sustainability on a small scale was in the city I was born and raised in, San Francisco. I distinctly remember that for all grades in elementary school, before us kids were allowed to leave the cafeteria after breakfast and lunch, we were given a visual and verbal demonstration on how to properly separate the trash in our food trays. "All food waste goes in the green compost bin, and all plastics go in the black landfill bin," teachers would repeat, day after day. I thought all cities and schools were being taught how to properly separate compostable waste from landfill and recycling waste. However, learning that was not the case when I came to Los Angeles to attend college was somewhat of a culture shock to me. Upon seeing trash sorted improperly, I realized how much I cared about sustainability. Although this project doesn't necessarily have to do with properly sorting trash, I am still equally as passionate about it because it has to do with sustainability, and my personal belief is that sustainability has to start somewhere small. Even if it's just one switch from a single-use item to a more sustainable alternative, the momentum of changes towards a more eco-friendly lifestyle can continue moving forward and inspire others."

Rafael Amezcua

"Sustainability has always been a huge factor in my life. Since I could remember, my clothes were passed to me by my cousins. It taught me how to survive on a budget, but also not to let things go to waste. For me, sustainability is not just about the environment, it's also about equity and access. We owe it to the generations to follow to an inherently better world. Through my roles in student leadership and campus outreach, I've witnessed how small grassroots initiatives create real impact. Cycle Care allows me to merge my project management skills with the personal belief that service means building systems that outlast you. With the help of the community, I hope to foster a culture where students are empowered to make sustainable choices, save money, and strengthen their community in the process."

Personal Skill Development

Through Cycle Care, both of us will develop transferable professional skills that extend beyond any classroom:

- **Organization Skills:** Managing a project that alternates between two campuses and an online social media campaign requires coordination. Challenging us to plan for risks and manage our time effectively, keeping a smooth operation throughout the duration of our project.
- **Interpersonal Skills:** Collaborations with student clubs, faculty, and peers will give us more real-life experience on how to accurately conduct outreach for events. Engaging with donors and workshop participants requires clear communication and the key ability to listen to what our community values most.
- **Leadership Skills**: A successful project always includes initiative to execute a plan, this project will have many opportunities for us to take charge of our own path. Building confidence and modeling accountability while motivating consistent engagement for deliverables.
- **Rafael Amezcua:** "It directly supports my career path, where I am to take on roles that combine leadership with community engagement. Managing a project like Cycle Care mimics the type of challenges I expect in my future career, whether it is balancing resources, promoting participation, and creating meaningful impact."
- Winnie Bai: "A large part of project management is sending documents back and forth to managers, and tweaking them according to any received feedback. Creating and implementing a project like this from start to finish gives me the full experience of what it's like in the real world, and I learn to embrace, adapt, and navigate changes to the project as they come."

Professional Insight Interview

Professor Lisa Chaddock

Geography Professor at San Diego City College, with extensive experience in sustainability education, field-based learning and leading campus/community partnerships

Why:

Professor Chaddock bridges classroom practice, campus operations, and community engagement at SDCC, which is exactly the vision Cycle Care seeks to emulate. Her insight can guide us in structuring events and partnerships both feasible on campus and impactful for the broader community.

How:

We plan to reach out via email, introducing Cycle Care and requesting a short Zoom or in-person interview. (20-30 minutes). We will highlight alignment with our goals and emphasize that her guidance will shape our deliverables. If unavailable, we will also explore other sustainability leaders in our communities. (e.g., Basic Needs Center staff or local nonprofit partners),

What We Hope to Learn:

- Campus partnerships that last: Help build collaborations (Basic Need Centers, clubs, and facilities) that remain active beyond our semester.
- Best practices for student-led sustainability initiatives: Lessons from past projects that succeeded or faced obstacles.
- Scaling Impact: How to replicate Cycle Care across multiple campuses or in different community settings.
- Measuring Outcomes: Approaches to capture impact in ways that help with both students and administration.,